C. Idioms related to Sports

The world of sports has given us many idiomatic expressions like 'blow-by-blow.' Read the description of each of the idioms given below. Then match these idioms with their meaning given in the box.

i) **throw in the towel:** Wet towels are kept near a boxing ring to wipe the sweat of boxers between rounds. When a boxer was getting badly beaten, his manager would throw a towel in the ring to end the fight.

ii) **in our corner:** In a boxing match, the corners are the two opposite angles of a boxing ring where the boxers rest between rounds.

iii) **on the ropes:** Boxing rings are typically enclosed by four ropes. As a boxer when your opponent has forced you against the ropes with his/her attack, you are in trouble.

iv) **below the belt:** Hits below the beltline are generally considered illegal in boxing.

v) **square off:** facing each other at the beginning of a match

Meaning

a. state of near collapse or defeat

b. unfair or unsporting behaviour

c. prepare for a conflict

d. on your side in an argument or dispute

e. to give up

Listening Activity

Read the questions based on the running commentary of a cricket match. Then, listen to the running commentary of the match read out by your teacher or played on the recorder and tick the right answers.

i) Who faced the first ball in the 49th over?

a)Kulasekara
b)Yuvraj
c) Dhoni
d) Sachin

ii) Which batsman hit a sixer?

a) Kulasekara
b) Bajji
c) Dhoni
d) Yuvraj

iii) Where was the match held?

a) Chennai
b) Delhi
c) Calcutta
d) Mumbai

iv) Who were popularly called 'The Finishers'?

a) Dhoni and Yuvaraj
b) Bajji and Malinga
c) Gambhir and Yuvaraj
d) Perara and Malinga

v) How many runs did India need to win the match in the last four overs?

a) 21
b) 27
c) 30
d) 37

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